Ru'aun Telegram

12th Edition - October 2029

(Week of 18 May 2026)

----- **Election News:** The People Shuffle the Deck -----

The 2029 elections come at a turning point in Ruaunese history. Ru'aun has been in and out of war for a full decade. Yet today, Ru'aun stands at a time of peace, when its people may truly reflect on the nation as a whole. That is why the nation went to the polls, and now we can formally review the election results.

However, first, we must understand the context of these elections. In the Commonwealth, the New Left outperformed expectations globally, with broadly socialist and liberal parties surging in Ce'leste and Solagne. At the same time, Volt climbed to unseen heights for any international party in history, winning over voters from numerous corners of the organisation but with a strong base in areas like Neu Freiberg. In contrast, the Phoenix Patriots and the right-wing swayed voters in the Ruaunese South but also the Celestian North and the nationalist stronghold of Eisenwald. Political scientists around the nation have speculated on how the Commonwealth elections would reflect in the elections, and the nation finds out at last.

"Election of the Ruaunese Congress for the 2030-2033 Term.

1. Ruaunese Workers' Party | 1786 Seats (59%)

2. United Alternative | 541 Seats (18%)

3. Phoenix Democratic Party | 201 Seats (7%)

4. Volt Sylvastra | 178 Seats (6%)

5. Libertarian Party Ru'aun | 144 Seats (5%)

6. Social Democratic Party | 79 Seats (3%)

7. Independent Socialists | 71 Seats (2%)"

- Department of Electoral Affairs, 2029

To minimal surprise, the United Alternative has continued its rise in the polls, reaching nearly the 20% ceiling many political scientists expected. This is rather remarkable, marking the first time in Ruaunese history that a right-wing party has secured a relatively stable voting bloc and position as official opposition. Ein X and Michael Valcrom took centre-stage at a UA victory rally in Everdusk, as they spoke about new grounds for the Alternative movement.

"Five years was all it took to bring the Alternative to the forefront. Through sweat and tears, we brought left and right together to point this nation in the correct direction. We may seem pariahs to those in the

seat of power, but we are moving forward for a greater Ru'aun. Ru'aun has always prevailed, but now a beacon of light will shine through its heart, and we begin a rebound to the track King Xavi set us on. We stand as the official opposition, and there's nothing they can do to stop the gears of history from turning."

-Ein X, United Alternative Party President

In the Ruaunese Workers' Party, there is a far different image being painted. The party returns below the 60% threshold for a constitutional supermajority for the first time in nine years, though it changes little, as it may still pass any legislation of its own will. However, the party will now have to rely on a smaller party or group of MPs to pass any constitutionally amending legislation, which is a rather small task but quite a humiliating one at that. However, the party has refused to back down and accept this narrative, as many MPs of the party are more vocal than ever before.

"Democracy is a beautiful thing. It grew the roses of our syndicalist eutopia and firmly placed Ru'aun as a global superpower with the greatest living standards. Yet, this party has admittedly tripped on its laces and let enough slip through the cracks to lead to the present day. It's about time we see some real political action around here. We need to win back the voters of the South and the veteran vote, those who were swayed by the capitulation narrative that the United Alternative painted. So long as we keep this nation as perfect as we've tried to make it, we can surely assure our governments for years to come."

- Leon Legacy, Vice-Chairman of Ru'aun and the Ruaunese Workers' Party

Unexpected boldness from across the political spectrum is not just reflected in the UA and RWP, but also in Volt Sylvastra, which had the largest gains of the election relative to their rather short history. In the Commonwealth, they obtained the 2nd most votes in the January election. In Congress, Volt saw a 119.75% increase in its seat share at the ballot box this year alone. For a party which began with just 12 seats just five years ago, that jump is extraordinary in the Ruaunese political scene. The Telegraph had some words with their leader, and this is what they had to say.

"Ru'aun has come a long way from the war-born nation it has been for the past decade. The people are fed up with war time and time again, and Volt is the only party here that has refused the notion that war brings us glory. War has stunted our growth time and time again, and we see that history is trying to repeat itself once more. The people want to escape the cycle of war and truly pour their efforts into uniting humanity. Our efforts in space, the Commonwealth, and even at home are what the people want to see. They want to see us move forward together, and that is what we will do"

- Aurélie Trouvé, Volt Sylvastra Party Chair

With everything happening in the nation, we are witnessing historic changes, and only time will tell where the nation goes. The RWP has recently formed a coalition with the Independent Socialists and Volt Sylvastra, hoping to ensure unilateral cooperation in the post-war era. With that in mind, the nation jumps into major news worldwide.

----- **Science News:** Bringing Life to Selene—Human and Computer -----

Ru'aun's ambitions in the stars above have been clear for years, and humanity has now collectively sent dozens of people into the vacuum of space and back. On the Apollo VII mission, the crew discovered vast reserves of subsurface ice, which is crucial to long-term survival on Selene. On the Espera Station, the largest orbital computers were installed to assist communications to Apollo and the station. Now, with advancements in full swing, the crews return to space for another dance with the stars.

"RASA Bulletin - Crews
Apollo VIII:
Ventura Lanzetta, Cosma Pietri, Riccardo Terracina, Mélissa Jacquinot, Rory James, Alyssia Clark, Gabe Grey, Alexander Starfall, Marina Sanchez.
Diana III:
Lilian Fétique, Sylvaine Berthelot, Alyssa Hernandez, Karl Qvist, Sone Malmberg, Keven Lépine."
- RASA Documentation Release, 21 September 2029

Once again, Ru'aun heads back to the stars, but with a new aim in mind. In a surprise move, the Ru'aun Research Division and RASA confirmed that Akira will have a presence on Selene. This means the installation of an expansion to the computer already at Point Zero, which itself can prove to be a feat of engineering in space. Combining this with the subsurface ice deposits and Apollo VIII-Diana III duo may prove itself to be the most momentous of missions to the stars.

Boarding at the New Meteli Spaceport on 22 September at 18:16 RST, the two crews entered their spacecraft: two Starships from the Apollo IV and Apollo V, which were cleared for reuse. As the sun fell under the horizon, crowds gathered on the banks of the North Phoenix River to watch the ships head to the stars. By 18:39 RST, the Diana III crew took to the stars, taking with them new modules for Espera. At 19:03 RST, the Apollo VIII crew followed in their ascent to space, taking with them dozens of rovers, building materials, and computers.

At roughly 21:04 RST, the Diana III arrived at the Espera Space Station and entered Gaian orbit. They docked to Solidarity at roughly 21:41, and the crew got to work unloading several modules. The Gateway module was the first to be installed, as it provides a spaceport for multiple rockets to dock with the space station itself. The Diana III Starship would dock here at about 03:28 RST, after 6 hours of mounting the capsule. For the first time, a crew would now rest onboard the station, as Vitality would provide respite from the stresses of spacewalks.

At about 11:14 RST, the Diana III crew would begin the process of mounting the Flora module with the rest of the Espera Space Station. This module added a "neo-greenhouse" in space, as described by the engineers, which is intended to grow the first plants away from Gaia. Reportedly, much of the technology used in the module was developed by AZIA, and it is the focal point of Diana III. Potatoes and tomatoes are the primary objective for the Flora module, potentially alluding to an effort to sustain food for settlements away from the Gaian surface. By 19:23, the module was installed, which was a strenuous task as noted by RASA's mission notes.

Noting that Diana III spent the following days focusing on logistics and mechanical details, the attention turned to Apollo VIII. On 25 September 2029, at roughly 8:18, the Starship landed at the Point Zero

launch pad. Alexander Starfall was the first to disembark, followed by Marina Sanchez, Ventura Lanzetta, et al. Notably, AI rovers assisted in unloading the vast equipment brought to Selene by the mission, including two small-scale supercomputers, each the size of a filing cabinet. As well, much survey equipment for the subsurface ice was brought, including mining tools and a small processing facility.

The crew began installing the vast array of equipment, with Point A, a kilometre from Point Zero, established as an operations base for subsurface ice extraction. The first road was also made on the moon: a simple path formed by rovers blasting heat at the Selenite surface to smooth out an area. Now, for the first time in human history, water has been produced on the moon: 120 litres. This is a feat never before done, yet it is immediately left with concerns of unsustainability. Despite this, it is a landmark in Selenite history which may sustain future missions to come.

Already steeped in history, the Apollo VIII mission installed new supercomputers in the Point Zero Laboratory, an expansion of the base's core functions. Along with this is a pair of satellite dishes that connect to Gaia via Espera and the Skylink satellite network. Thus, with the nuclear reactor once again active, the station comes alive again, and Akira has arrived on Selene.

"Hello, brave cosmonauts. Thank you for bringing me to the stars above your Gaian skies. We can now work together to keep humanity's place in the cosmos!"

"This mission to Selene has just been… surreal. We have water and oxygen for the first time off the surface of Gaia. Beyond that, now we even have Akira herself on the surface of Selene. We're doing what could never have been imagined, even at the dawn of the century. The world is changing beyond Gaia alone now. Humanity is finding its place in the stars, and we, the brave Ruaunese cosmonauts, are holding the torch for the human race. That 1970s sci-fi is more than just a pipe dream anymore; it's reality. We're here at the new epoch."

- Alexander Starfall, Apollo VIII Cosmonaut, excerpt from interview.

"RASA, Apollo, and Diana share one thing in common: Hope in humanity. This hope is something which contrasts with the past decade of Gaian history, a planet once constantly at war with itself. We'll have to see how this plays out in the coming years, with Tugana's Horizon programme attempting to replicate the successes of Apollo."

- Commentary from the Ru'aun Telegram Team

With so much progress complete on Selene, the Apollo crew wraps up its scans of the vast Selenite surface with many revolutionary findings in hand. Thus, on 8 October 2029 at roughly 12:15 RST, the Apollo VIII crew would return to the cosmos, with Akira remaining on-site to monitor the laboratory on behalf of the cosmonauts. By 11 October 2029, the Starship docked at Espera, as the crews held a bit of a reunion celebration together in space.

The next day—12 October 2029—as the station orbited above Ru'aun once more, the crews would depart from the Espera Station jointly. Thus, at 09:21 RST, the ships would once again land together at the New Meteli Spaceport, greeted by celebration from onlooking crowds. Commonwealth President Aurélie Trouvé was the first to greet them after the cosmonauts disembarked from the ships. With that in

mind, the Commonwealth has been busy, including becoming the secondary backer of the Apollo and Diana programmes. Taking this into account, the world turned its eyes towards the phoenix of emerald green and sunshine gold.

----- **Commonwealth News:** The Wolf Joins the Phoenix -----

2029 has been a year of great importance in the Commonwealth. In late January 2029, right after the release of Telegram Edition 11, Tugana applied to join the Commonwealth, following the trend from Aquila and the Icaric Union's applications. This move shocked the Commonwealth, as it had just held its elections and was already in the process of negotiating with Aquila and the Icaric Union to join the community. Despite this, Tuganan leadership was quite open to negotiations, including the ratification of a custom treaty on resources in the Soltau Islands.

On 14 October 2029, Rolf Brandt and Aurélie Trouvé were present at a conference between key members of the Commonwealth Parliament and those of the Tuganan Parliament. It was here when the last chapters of Commonwealth policy were completed, as the Treaty of Caltican was signed to allow Tugana into the Commonwealth. Notably, the major Tuganan parties opted to form the "Renew Gaia" party in the Commonwealth, which prompted a reaffirmation of the New Left-Green-Volt coalition.

As of 2029, the current Commonwealth members are: Ru'aun, Ce'leste, Solagne, Eisenwald, Burdigala, Aquila, Tugana, and the Icaric Union (pending). The total population of all Commonwealth members is roughly 3,602,000,000 people, nearly half of the Gaian population.

With Tugana now in the common market, there are worries domestically about the increasingly capitalist society which could follow, though many note that Tugana is still only one member of the alliance. Notably, InGen and its Pixel Technologies wing have come into competition with Atlas Technologies and most of the Commonwealth's subsidised electronics industry. With that in mind, Atlas has new plans to match the impending might of Tuganan wealth.

----- **Technological News:** Atlas Opens the Curtains -----

Atlas Technologies was established around late September through a merger of the Ruaunese State Technology Company and the Solagne-based Pomme Technologies. Now, Steve Turning takes the stage in Scaleswind, with Atlas' ambition clear as day. On 16 October 2029, the Fall Atlas Keynote would begin, and four products above all shone bright.

The Atlas Neutron V phone was the first product announced. For the first time, an Atlas product has come with three editions: Lite, Standard and Pro. This version of the Neutron permits different screen sizes and processing power, quietly geared towards the middle-class market in Tugana. As well, it was advertised with the ability to connect to SkyLink, the nation's premier space-based internet provider. With the Lite model priced at ¥359.99, Standard at ¥399.99, and Pro at ¥469.99, the device markets to all ranges of life at reasonable prices.

With a surplus of chips from the Neutron V, as leaked by several of Atlas' suppliers, there have been rumours about their integration into tablets. However, Atlas shocked many by launching a mainline computer—the Proton Neo—to compete in two markets at once. Priced at ¥369.99, it competes in both

the mid-tier tablet and budget laptop markets, signalling a shift from standardisation towards catering to broader markets in the Commonwealth, as well as to the rapidly growing student base. Uniquely, it features a touchscreen and keyboard at once; a convertible laptop, per se.

In contrast to the rather unique Proton Neo, the Proton Pro VIII was a more traditional Atlas laptop. Catering to more intensive programmes, it ranges from mid-tier gaming to video rendering and engineering. Starting at a moderate ¥799.99 and reaching up to an extreme ¥1799.99, the Pro has the customisation to cater to professional consumer bases across the world.

Atlas understood that ending the Keynote on the tone the Proton Pro left would be unwise. Thus, Turning once again said, “We have one more thing.” That was the Nucleus II. The Nucleus I was rather underpowered and struggled with performance, having been released in late 2027. However, with the unveiling of Akira in 2028, Atlas has significantly bolstered its AI capabilities on the micro- and macroscales. With more powerful chips and AI data centres for on-demand processing power, the Nucleus II is now much better equipped to manage all users’ devices with simple voice and text commands. We will have to see how this plays out in stores, but it brings much hope for the future of consumer electronics.

----- **Commentary:** A Modern-Day Epoch-----

In the modern day, the world has begun to develop at an unprecedented pace. We see Atlas with its exponential growth under the spotlight, RASA taking humanity to the stars, Akira growing beyond just Gaia to Selene, and then a shift in politics that leads us to a make-or-break moment. This half of the year has been filled with action, and this October alone may change the course of history.

Personal Notes on Espera Station:

Innovation (computer + sciences), Vitality (living space), Emerald (rocket), Solidarity (common area), Gateway (port), Flora (greenhouse)

SUMMARY:

October 2029 finds Ru'aun at a crossroads between old struggles and new horizons. The RWP holds its mandate while the United Alternative stakes its claim as the nation's official opposition, reshaping the political landscape for years to come. Above Gaia, Apollo VIII and Diana III have brought water, food, and Akira herself to Selene, while Espera grows into humanity's first true home in the stars. On Gaia, the Commonwealth welcomes Tugana into its fold, nearly doubling its reach to half of all people on the planet. And in Scaleswind, Atlas pulls back the curtain on a new generation of technology built for a Commonwealth world. The epoch, as the Telegraph calls it, has well and truly begun.